

American Express Campus Challenge 2026

It's about Premier Card

Agenda

- Background of Campus Challenge
- Stages of Competition
 - Round1 – Measuring the Customer Profitability for Premier Product

Background

Let's see, what The American Express Campus Challenge 2026 is all about?

The **American Express Campus Challenge** is an analytics and data science-based competition for campus students. It's a platform to showcase your talent and compete with the best minds across India.

American Express India Centre of Excellence (CoE) is a two-decade-old establishment serving as an “analytical powerhouse” for American Express. Our Decision Science & Strategy teams across Risk, Fraud, and Marketing are the backbone of all data-driven decisions across the customer life cycle at American Express. How do you engage with a customer? Should a card be approved or declined? How much credit should be extended to the customer? Is it really the customer making the transaction – or is it a fraudster? To solve these problems, we leverage rich data and the next generation of AI and technology.

In this year’s competition, we are looking for innovative minds to express their proficiency in data analytics & formulate an decision science solution:
As a Data Modeler, apply data science and predictive modelling skills, learn on the way from the data, and try out new ideas to produce the most accurate prediction model for matches.

What's in it for you?

Exciting **prizes** for the winners & top performers!

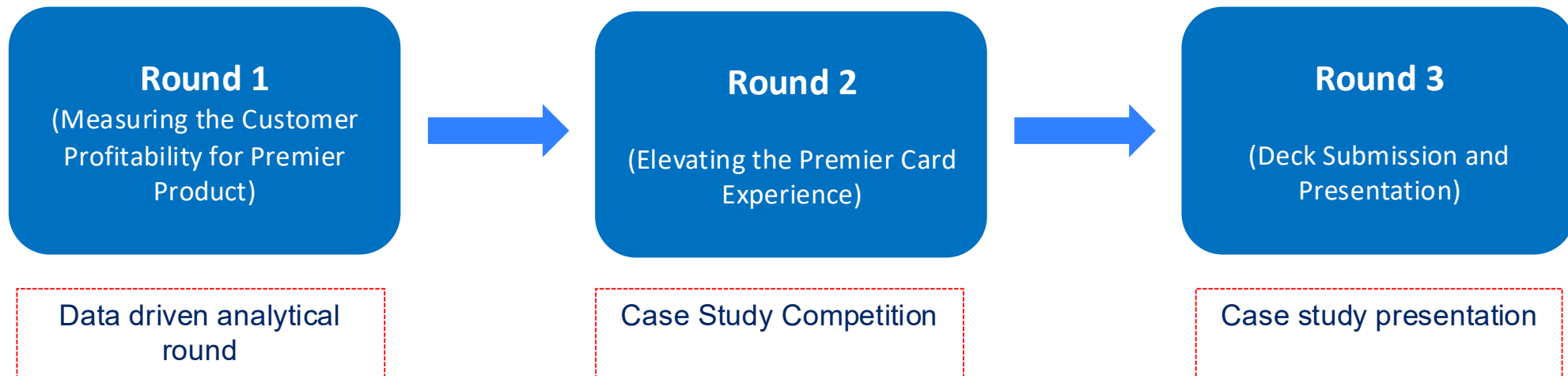
***Pre-Placement Interviews (PPIs)** for top performers!

Amex merchandise & participation certificates!

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Stages of Competition



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Round 1

Problem Statement

- Identify the most profitable premier Cardmembers based on attributes such as spend behavior, revolving patterns, riskiness and benefit utilization
- The objective of this problem is to design a framework or equation to quantify cardmember profitability to issuer by incorporating revenues and costs, in order to identify and prioritize the most profitable customers

Overview of Premier Card Product

Key features, rewards structure, credits, and value proposition

POSITIONING & FEE

- Flagship personal ultra-premium card
- Annual Fee: \$500 – \$750
- Target: High-income, frequent travelers
- No preset spending limit (charge card)

REWARDS RATE & MULTIPLIERS

- 5x CC points on flights booked directly / Travel
- 5x CC points on prepaid hotels via Travel
- 1x CC points on all other purchases
- 1 CC points ≈ 1-2 cents (transfer to partners)
- Transfer to 20+ airline & hotel partners

WELCOME & RENEWAL

- Welcome bonus: 80,000-150,000 CC points
- (on spending threshold in first 6 months)
- No renewal bonus; value via annual credits
- Retention offers available upon request

TRAVEL BENEFITS

- Ultra Premium Lounge access (cardholder + 2 guests)
- **Priority airport services and travel conveniences**
- Premier Airlines
- \$150 - \$250 airline fee credit (select airline/year)
- Trip cancellation/interruption insurance
- Car rental loss & damage insurance

HOTEL & LOYALTY STATUS

- **Elite status with luxurious hotel loyalty program**
- Premium hotels **room upgrades + credits**
- **Hotel stay credits and special offers (E.g. \$50 - \$150 credit on 2-night stays)**

LIFESTYLE CREDITS (ANNUAL)

- \$150-\$250 Cabs credit (\$15/mo + \$20 Dec)
- \$180 - \$280 Digital entertainment credit
- \$105 - \$205 Commerce Stores
- \$250 - \$350 Fitness
- \$50 - \$150 Clothing credit

PROTECTION & INSURANCE

- Purchase protection (120 days, up to \$5K - \$15K)
- Extended warranty (+2 years on purchases)
- Return protection (90 days, up to \$250 - \$350/item)
- Fraud protection with zero liability
- Emergency card replacement worldwide

DIGITAL & APP EXPERIENCE

- Real-time spend notifications & alerts
- CC points tracker & transfer in-app
- Virtual card numbers for online use
- Plan It: installment flexibility
- Offers: targeted merchant deals

Card Member Attributes : Categories

- We have a total of ~30 attributes spread across different categories
- **Attribute Names will be masked and No PII will be shared**

CM spend & balance

- Industry level spends
- Revolve behavior

Benefit Usage

- No of lounge visits
- No of months Cab credits are utilized

Engagement

- No of calls to cancel premier card
- Website logins
- # of Cards held

Profile

- Tenure
- Size of Wallet
- Riskiness score
- Bureau score

Dataset Details

You are provided with a dataset having following details:

- Size – 500K records
- Contains only the Cardmember attributes
- Objective: Develop a profitability framework to rank order the cardmembers based on estimated profitability

Evaluation Criteria: Accuracy

- Accuracy measured as percentage of Actual Top 20% vs Top 20% profitable CMs identified
- Main dataset is divided into 2 parts randomly (70/30)

Public Leaderboard:

- Final Score will be Accuracy on 70% data. It will be live leaderboard rank ordered basis attained score and publicly available for students

Private Leaderboard:

- Final Score will be Accuracy on 30% data. It will be hidden leaderboard and published post R1 completion.

Round 1 Guidelines

- Participants will need to use existing variables in formulating their equation
- Participants must not use identifier variables in their solution
- Participants are not allowed to add new rows or alter the shared data
- The created solution must be run on all `unique_identifiers`
- Participants need to submit 1 file in Round 1
- Participants are required to download and follow exact templates of the submission files from Unstop website
- Participants should try to create an equation that is scalable in real world, keeping in mind the evaluation criteria
- Max submissions allowed per team in Round 1 are 10, leaderboard 1 would be public basis submission of File and team would be rank ordered basis max final score attained. Leaderboard 2 will be hidden and published at the end of Round 1
- Amex will be thoroughly evaluating all solutions to ensure integrity & guarding against any misuse or gaming
- Plagiarism of solutions will lead to disqualification for all involved teams
- The decision of all matters shall be binding and final. American Express shall not be obligated to provide any explanation or justification for its decisions.